

D591

Grant Writing

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

Items

1.

A small nonprofit focused on preventing youth tobacco use, which recently celebrated its 20th anniversary, finds a \$500,000 federal opportunity for adult dental care services. What is the best decision?

- A. Apply to every opportunity to maximize the chance of funding.
- B. Apply now and adjust its mission after winning.
- C. Do not apply; focus on opportunities that fit its mission and capacity.
- D. Apply, because \$500,000 would greatly expand its budget.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An organization's mission is reducing youth vaping. Which funding opportunity fits best?

- A. The largest grant available, regardless of topic.
- B. A federal grant for fall prevention in older adults.
- C. A grant for adult opioid treatment.
- D. A foundation call for school-based youth nicotine prevention programs.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A federal funding notice requires a 10-page narrative in 12-point font, submitted online by 5 p.m. Eastern. The team, which hired an award-winning graphic designer, has a strong 13-page narrative. What should it do?

- A. Cut the narrative to 10 pages in the required format.
- B. Add designer graphics to make the extra pages attractive.
- C. Shrink the font to 10 points to fit 13 pages of text.
- D. Submit all 13 pages, since the content is strong.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A draft need statement from a nonprofit that just unveiled a new logo reads: Our organization needs \$80,000 to hire a coordinator because our budget is tight. Which revision is strongest?

- A. Our new logo shows our commitment to youth.
- B. Nationally, teen births cost taxpayers billions each year.
- C. The county's teen birth rate is 32 per 1,000, nearly double the state rate of 17, and no school-based program serves its three high schools.
- D. A moving story about one teen parent, with no data.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement frames the need around the community rather than the organization?

- A. We need funds to cover our staff salaries.
- B. Everyone deserves good health.
- C. Forty percent of residents in two zip codes live more than 20 miles from a clinic offering free screenings.
- D. We have operated for 20 years.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A proposal's direct costs total \$120,000. The organization's negotiated indirect rate is 15% of direct costs. Its board chair is a retired accountant. What total amount should it request?

- A. \$120,000
- B. \$102,000
- C. \$18,000
- D. \$138,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A funder caps total awards at \$115,000, including indirect costs at 15% of direct costs. What is the maximum direct-cost budget?

- A. \$100,000
- B. \$17,250
- C. \$115,000
- D. \$97,750

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An objective states: By June 30, 2027, 70% of 200 enrolled parents will correctly install a car seat during an observed check. The program office is next to a fire station. Which evaluation measure fits best?

- A. A parent satisfaction survey.
- B. The percentage of enrolled parents who pass an observed car-seat check by a certified technician by June 30, compared with the 70% target.
- C. The number of flyers distributed.
- D. Whether 200 parents enrolled.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A reviewer notes that a three-year program, run by an organization that recently moved into a donated building, appears to end when the grant ends. Which sustainability plan is strongest?

- A. Apply to the same funder for renewal.
- B. Diversify funding (for example, insurance billing where eligible and a county budget line), secure partner in-kind commitments, and train partner staff to continue key services.
- C. The program will continue because it is effective.
- D. Rent out the donated building.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A nonprofit whose executive director is well known in the state capitol is gathering partner letters for a school-based program. Which letter will most strengthen the proposal?

- A. Letters from several elected officials who know the director.
- B. A school district letter committing two classrooms two afternoons a week and a staff liaison.
- C. A letter praising the nonprofit's reputation.
- D. Letters that partners will write after the award.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A funder requires a 1:1 cash match for a \$60,000 grant. The applicant, founded by a group of nurses, has \$25,000 in cash and \$40,000 in donated volunteer time. Can it meet the match?

- A.** Yes; \$65,000 in total resources exceeds \$60,000.
- B.** Yes; match requirements are always optional.
- C.** No; it needs \$60,000 more in cash.
- D.** No; it needs \$35,000 more in cash.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A funder requires a match equal to 25% of total project cost. The organization requests \$90,000 from the funder. How much match is required?

- A.** \$30,000
- B.** \$90,000
- C.** \$22,500
- D.** \$120,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A small nonprofit focused on preventing youth tobacco use, ~~which recently celebrated its 20th anniversary,~~ finds a \$500,000 federal opportunity for adult dental care services. What is the best decision?

Target word: go/no-go **Decides:** The opportunity falls outside the mission.

A	Absolute language	Scattershot applications waste effort and harm credibility.
B	Inverted operation	Mission should drive grant choices, not the reverse.
C	Correct	Misaligned grants cause mission drift and weak proposals.
D	Wrong stem number	Size of the award does not decide fit.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

An organization's mission is reducing youth vaping. Which funding opportunity fits best?

Target word: best-aligned opportunity **Decides:** Matches population and issue.

A	Dropped element	Drops mission fit from the decision.
B	Adjacent category	Prevention work, but a different population and issue.
C	Confusion set	Substance-related, but a different substance and population.
D	Correct	Same population and issue as the mission.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A federal funding notice requires a 10-page narrative in 12-point font, submitted online by 5 p.m. Eastern. The team, ~~which hired an award-winning graphic designer,~~ has a strong 13-page narrative. What should it do?

Target word: compliance decision **Decides:** The notice sets a firm page limit.

A	Correct	Noncompliant applications can be rejected without review.
B	Camouflage	Design does not fix the page-limit violation.
C	Dropped element	Violates the font requirement.
D	Inverted operation	Content does not override compliance rules.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A draft need statement from a nonprofit ~~that just unveiled a new logo~~ reads: Our organization needs \$80,000 to hire a coordinator because our budget is tight. Which revision is strongest?

Target word: strongest need statement **Decides:** Community data and a service gap.

A	Camouflage	Branding is not need.
B	Adjacent category	National figures do not show local need.
C	Correct	Local data show the problem and the gap.
D	Dropped element	Stories help but need data to establish need.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

Which statement frames the need around the community rather than the organization?

Target word: community-centered statement **Decides:** Describes people affected and a gap.

A	Inverted operation	Centers the organization's need.
B	Absolute language	A value statement with no evidence of need.
C	Correct	States a community problem with data.
D	Confusion set	Shows capacity, not need.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A proposal's direct costs total \$120,000. The organization's negotiated indirect rate is 15% of direct costs. ~~Its board chair is a retired accountant.~~ What total amount should it request?

Target word: total request **Decides:** \$120,000 + 15% of \$120,000.

A	Wrong stem number	Direct costs only.
B	Inverted operation	Subtracts indirect costs instead of adding them.
C	Dropped element	The indirect amount alone.
D	Correct	$\$120,000 \times 0.15 = \$18,000$; $\$120,000 + \$18,000 = \$138,000$.

7. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A funder caps total awards at \$115,000, including indirect costs at 15% of direct costs. What is the maximum direct-cost budget?

Target word: solve for direct costs **Decides:** $\$115,000 / 1.15$.

A	Correct	$\$100,000 + 15\% (\$15,000) = \$115,000$.
B	Adjacent category	15% of the cap, not a direct-cost budget.
C	Dropped element	Leaves no room for indirect costs.
D	Confusion set	Takes 15% off the total; the rate applies to direct costs.

8. Answer B Concept 5

An objective states: By June 30, 2027, 70% of 200 enrolled parents will correctly install a car seat during an observed check. ~~The program office is next to a fire station.~~ Which evaluation measure fits best?

Target word: measure matched to objective **Decides:** Objective is correct installation on observed check.

A	Adjacent category	Satisfaction does not show correct installation.
B	Correct	Measures exactly what the objective states.
C	Confusion set	An output, not the outcome.
D	Dropped element	Enrollment leaves out the skill being measured.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A reviewer notes that a three-year program, ~~run by an organization that recently moved into a donated building~~, appears to end when the grant ends. Which sustainability plan is strongest?

Target word: strongest sustainability plan **Decides:** Diverse, committed support after the grant.

A	Dropped element	A single, uncertain source.
B	Correct	Multiple sources and built capacity keep services going.
C	Absolute language	Effectiveness does not guarantee funding.
D	Camouflage	Reacts to the building detail rather than a plan for services.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A nonprofit ~~whose executive director is well known in the state capitol~~ is gathering partner letters for a school-based program. Which letter will most strengthen the proposal?

Target word: strongest letter **Decides:** Specific committed role and resources.

A	Camouflage	Relationships do not show partner roles.
B	Correct	Specific commitments show feasibility.
C	Adjacent category	Support without commitment.
D	Inverted operation	Letters must be in the application.

11. Answer D Concept 8

A funder requires a 1:1 cash match for a \$60,000 grant. The applicant, ~~founded by a group of nurses~~, has \$25,000 in cash and \$40,000 in donated volunteer time. Can it meet the match?

Target word: match status **Decides:** Match must be cash; in-kind does not count.

A	Confusion set	Counts in-kind time toward a cash match.
B	Absolute language	Required match is a condition of the award.
C	Dropped element	Ignores the \$25,000 already on hand.
D	Correct	\$60,000 cash needed – \$25,000 on hand = \$35,000.

12. Answer A Concept 8 • transfer

A funder requires a match equal to 25% of total project cost. The organization requests \$90,000 from the funder. How much match is required?

Target word: solve for match **Decides:** Total = \$90,000 / 0.75 = \$120,000.

A	Correct	Total \$120,000 × 25% = \$30,000; \$90,000 + \$30,000 = \$120,000.
B	Wrong stem number	The grant request.
C	Confusion set	25% of the grant, not of total cost.
D	Adjacent category	The total project cost.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	8	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Mission alignment (go/no-go)	Apply only for grants that fit the organization's mission and capacity; a large award outside the mission causes mission drift.	Chasing money because the amount is large.	An opportunity whose focus differs from the organization's work.
2	Follow the funding notice exactly	Page limits, formatting, required sections, and deadlines in the notice of funding opportunity are compliance rules; noncompliant applications can be rejected without review.	Thinking strong content excuses breaking format rules.	A draft that exceeds a stated limit.
3	Community-centered need statement	A need statement uses local data to show a community problem and a service gap, not the organization's own need for money.	Writing about the organization's budget or using only national figures.	"We need funding to..."
4	Indirect costs	Indirect costs = rate $\times$ base (often direct costs); total request = direct + indirect; under a total cap, max direct = cap $\div$ (1 + rate).	Requesting only the indirect figure, or taking the rate off the total.	An indirect cost rate and a direct-cost budget or total cap.
5	Evaluation aligned to objectives	Each objective needs a measure that directly shows whether its stated target was met.	Measuring satisfaction or outputs for an outcome objective.	A SMART objective followed by possible measures.
6	Sustainability planning	Show how the work continues after the grant through diverse funding, partner commitments, and built capacity.	Relying on renewal from the same funder or on the program's merit alone.	A reviewer asks what happens when the grant ends.
7	Letters of commitment	Partner letters are strongest when they commit specific roles, resources, and time, not general praise.	Collecting many generic support letters.	Choosing which partner letters to include.
8	Matching funds	Meet match requirements in the form the funder specifies (cash vs. in-kind); if match = % of total project, total = grant $\div$ (1 - %).	Counting in-kind toward a cash match, or taking the percent of the grant instead of the total.	A match ratio or percentage in the notice.

Course scope (public description): Grant Writing introduces learners to essential tasks and approaches to acquiring funding for public health projects and programs through grants. It addresses how to find and apply to both government and non-government grant opportunities. Learners practice researching for grants, determining which grants align with the mission and purpose of a public health program, evaluating draft grant proposals, and identifying and revising key components of a drafted proposal.